TECHNICAL DELIVERY CASE STUDY

After Hours Elevator Access

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I led a four-month integration that let residents of an occupied condo building grant temporary elevator access from the SmartONE app. The change let guests and delivery drivers get upstairs after hours, when the lobby had no concierge.

The problem in an occupied building

The elevators required a card to select a floor. When guests or delivery drivers reached the lobby after hours, residents had to come down to meet them. The building was already in service, which made a new wired connection to the elevator control panel impractical. The integration had to work through software with the access control system already installed.

The decision to involve CDVI

There were different views on who should handle the integration. I contacted both the security contractor that installed the building's access control system and CDVI, the manufacturer. The installer said its work was complete and saw no way to take the request further. I escalated the question to CDVI's technical team and explained what residents and property management needed the feature to do.

I brought CDVI's technical staff into discussions with SmartONE engineering and software. With CDVI involved, our software team identified what the integration needed. I documented the requirements in both directions so SmartONE and the security contractor knew what each side had to provide.

Testing and Launch

Coordinating the live site test

Someone had to be at the building to press the elevator buttons and verify how they responded while our software team adjusted the settings remotely. I worked through Customer Support to coordinate access and timing with the property manager. I made sure the people at the building and the software team knew what they were responsible for during the test.

The on-site tester verified that a person at the elevator could select a floor after access was released from the app.

Client acceptance and resident outcome

The property manager and the developer’s team accepted the feature after testing. Once it was live, residents could use a button in the app to release elevator access for a set period. That gave a guest or delivery driver time to get upstairs without the resident making a trip to the lobby.

After launch, we received no further complaints from property management about visitors getting stuck in the lobby after hours.

Documentation for future deployments

I documented the integration so another SmartONE engineering or software team could work with a security contractor on the same request at a future building. I also created separate instructions for property managers and residents on how to use the feature in the app.